

update you haven't installed already. If you are running Linux Mint 17, you do not need to reinstall. Please wait a little while. We'll provide updates to Linux Mint 17 and information in an upcoming announcement. Upgrading will be easy, fully supported and it will be an opt-in (i.e., you will have the choice to upgrade to 17.1 but also to keep 17 as it is)."

The 17.x branch of Linux Mint was built on the Ubuntu 14.04 LTS and, as Mint developers have decided, LTS versions will be used in the next releases too.

Manjaro Xfce 0.8.11 is out

Finally, there's a stable version of Manjaro Xfce. The Linux distribution is based on Arch Linux repositories. Developers had released a few release candidates before launching Manjaro 0.8.11. The new distribution packs in some changes and improvements. The version number doesn't reflect the number of improvements implemented in the new release. Manjaro Xfce 0.8.11 is the first major update after ver 0.8.10.

The Xfce edition is the stable flagship edition of Manjaro. The team of developers first tested the new components inhouse to ensure stability and suitability for day-to-day usage and then they shipped it to the Xfce series. Xfce 0.8.11 brings display locking, user switching, custom integration and LightDM for login management.

Manjaro Xfce 0.8.11 is based on the Linux kernel 3.16 series, which is known for its stability, modern features and hardware support. Manjaro has integrated an option to switch between systemd and OpenRC, which is a major change compared to the previous version. The new package management tool, Octopi, makes this switching of package management easier. There is a new tool that can uninstall the running kernel. Menda themes have been updated too. Developers have added a new feature to adjust date and time settings. Manjaro Xfce 0.8.11 is available for download for use as a live CD.

edX launches 'The Introduction to Linux' course

Never learned Linux? Want a refresh? Take this course on 'The Introduction to Linux', from edX. This course claims to help you develop a good working knowledge of Linux using both the graphical interface and command line, covering the major Linux distribution families. Linux powers 94 per cent of the world's supercomputers, most of the servers powering the Internet, the majority of financial trading worldwide and a billion Android devices.

This course explores the various tools and techniques commonly used by Linux system administrators and end users to achieve their day-to-day work in a Linux environment. It is designed for experienced computer users who have limited or no previous exposure to Linux, whether they are working in an individual or enterprise environment.

Upon completion of this training you should have a good working knowledge of Linux, from both a graphical and command line perspective, allowing you to easily navigate through any of the major Linux distributions. You will be able to continue your progress as either a user, systems administrator or developer, using the acquired skill sets.

This course is being taught by Jerry Cooperstein, who has been working with Linux since 1994, developing and delivering training in both the kernel and user space. He has overall responsibility for all training content at The Linux Foundation.



Offline mobile Internet service, SMSGyan, goes open source

Innoz founder, Deepak Ravindran, who is also the creator of an offline search engine, has released the source code for the offline Internet across countries like Pakistan, Sri Lanka, the Philippines, Thailand, Indonesia, Nigeria and Kenya, for telecom providers.

Ravindran launched SMSGyan when Indian mobile phone users were not too aware about online search, and within two years of its launch, his service made 120 million Indians go online. With this system, users can text any question. Innaz partnered with Wikipedia, Bing and Wolfram to crawl the Internet for answers to user queries. The service could also be used to send emails via Gmail, to post on Facebook and even tweet. Almost every telecom provider partnered with the product in India and it became a household name across devices.

Then Android entered the market and when low-end Android phones arrived, smartphone sales saw a huge boom. With the change in the market's trends, Ravindran and his team started exploring other markets like Africa and southeast Asia, where the Internet is neither very popular nor are smartphones. That's why Ravindran decided to release the source code for free via offlineinternet.org. This now means that the offline Internet service will be free.

Ravindran aims to reach out to the developer community by giving away the source code. This will benefit customers too, with the world-class technology advancements happening in the SMS market. Recently, Ravindran also launched a 'Whatsapp' for businesses in India, called 'Lookup'.